

bath, and an add-in for homemade cleaning sprays.

THE LIVING ROOM / FAMILY ROOM

Skip the Facial Tissue

Sure, it's in a larger, more pleasant shape, but when you need something to handle a sneeze or running nose, a standard roll of toilet paper does the job just as well. If you think your inner decorating diva can't quite handle this, consider a decorative container, or keep it in a drawer in your end table.

Lose the Cable

It's never been as easy to live without cable. Between Netflix and free online viewing of most TV shows, there's no longer a strong case to drop \$60 to \$200 each month for cable. You don't even need a TV to watch television anymore—just a computer and Internet connection.

Budget Decorating

The living and family areas really do have a ton of potential for budget and DIY decorating integration. Upholstery scraps for new bar-stool seats, homemade throw pillows and stapled-on throw covers for stained yet comfortably stuffed sofas and love seats. A few small touches can make

it look like you have brand-new furniture.

THE KITCHEN

DIY Dishrags

Got an old T-shirt or pair of sport socks that have seen better days? Sanitize them in the laundry and sacrifice them to the cause for a great way to keep it cheap and go green at the same time.

Multipurpose Homemade Spray Cleaner

Mix water with witch hazel, add a few drops of grapefruit seed extract and earth-friendly dish soap. You can also make other versions with vinegar or rubbing alcohol. You can find a variety of recipes online.

Go Generic

Don't have time to clip coupons or price-compare? Picking up generic store-brand items can easily shave 25% off your regular grocery total.

Keep Empty Bottles

When our juice bottles are empty, we keep them around for a bunch of things—to mix frozen juice in; use the bottom to make a toilet brush holder; use the top for a funnel. Why spend extra to purchase containers, when most things you buy come in one?